GRADE 5 ELA

Topic 3: Informational Text and Research Skills

Common Core–aligned multiple-choice question bank

150 questions • 50 Easy • 50 Medium • 50 Hard

Assesses informational-text comprehension, main idea, supporting details, inference, text structure, vocabulary in context, evidence-based conclusions, and evaluating information sources.

Instructions: Read each informational passage carefully. Select the best answer to each question. The answer key appears at the end. Correct answer positions are balanced across A, B, C, and D.

Easy Questions (50)

1. Read the passage: **Why City Trees Matter**

On a hot summer day, a street with trees can feel cooler than a street covered only with pavement. Leaves provide shade, and water released from leaves cools the surrounding air. Tree roots also help rain soak into the ground instead of rushing into drains. However, city trees need care: young trees must be watered, damaged branches should be removed, and roots need enough room to grow. Neighborhoods that plan carefully can choose trees suited to local weather and streets.

Question: Which statement best expresses the passage's main idea?

A. City trees provide shade, cool the air, and help manage rain, but they need thoughtful care.

B. Leaves provide shade and release water, which helps make nearby air cooler.

C. The passage explains benefits first and then describes care trees require.

D. Tree roots help rain soak into the ground instead of rushing into drains.

2. Read the passage: **Why City Trees Matter**

On a hot summer day, a street with trees can feel cooler than a street covered only with pavement. Leaves provide shade, and water released from leaves cools the surrounding air. Tree roots also help rain soak into the ground instead of rushing into drains. However, city trees need care: young trees must be watered, damaged branches should be removed, and roots need enough room to grow. Neighborhoods that plan carefully can choose trees suited to local weather and streets.

Question: Which detail from the passage supports the main idea?

A. A city should consider its climate and available space before choosing street trees.

B. Tree roots help rain soak into the ground instead of rushing into drains.

C. The word "suited" means well matched to a particular purpose or condition.

D. Leaves provide shade and release water, which helps make nearby air cooler.

3. Read the passage: **The Journey of a Plastic Bottle**

After a plastic bottle is placed in a recycling bin, it is collected and taken to a sorting facility. Workers and machines separate plastic from paper, metal, and other materials. The bottles are then cleaned and chopped into small flakes. Those flakes may be melted and shaped into material for new products, such as clothing fibers or containers. Recycling does not make waste disappear, and not every bottle is accepted everywhere. Rinsing containers and checking local rules can help the process work better.

Question: Which statement best expresses the passage's main idea?

A. Recycling plastic bottles involves collection, sorting, cleaning, and turning the plastic into material for new products.

B. The passage presents the stages of a process in time order.

C. Rinsing containers and following local rules can help recycling work more effectively.

D. At a sorting facility, plastic is separated from paper, metal, and other materials.

4. Read the passage: **The Journey of a Plastic Bottle**

After a plastic bottle is placed in a recycling bin, it is collected and taken to a sorting facility. Workers and machines separate plastic from paper, metal, and other materials. The bottles are then cleaned and chopped into small flakes. Those flakes may be melted and shaped into material for new products, such as clothing fibers or containers. Recycling does not make waste disappear, and not every bottle is accepted everywhere. Rinsing containers and checking local rules can help the process work better.

Question: Which detail from the passage supports the main idea?

A. At a sorting facility, plastic is separated from paper, metal, and other materials.

B. In this passage, "facility" means a place where a particular activity is carried out.

C. A bottle placed in a recycling bin is not instantly turned into a new product.

D. Rinsing containers and following local rules can help recycling work more effectively.

5. Read the passage: **How Bees Help Plants**

When a bee visits a flower to collect nectar, pollen can stick to its body. As the bee moves to another flower, some pollen may rub off. This transfer can help a plant produce seeds and, in many plants, fruit. Bees are not the only pollinators; butterflies, birds, bats, and wind can also move pollen. Different plants attract different pollinators with features such as color, scent, shape, and the time their flowers open.

Question: Which statement best expresses the passage's main idea?

A. Pollen can stick to a bee while it collects nectar.

B. The passage explains a process and then gives examples of other pollinators.

C. Pollen transfer can help a plant produce seeds and fruit.

D. Bees help many plants reproduce by carrying pollen from one flower to another.

6. Read the passage: **How Bees Help Plants**

When a bee visits a flower to collect nectar, pollen can stick to its body. As the bee moves to another flower, some pollen may rub off. This transfer can help a plant produce seeds and, in many plants, fruit. Bees are not the only pollinators; butterflies, birds, bats, and wind can also move pollen. Different plants attract different pollinators with features such as color, scent, shape, and the time their flowers open.

Question: Which detail from the passage supports the main idea?

A. Pollen transfer can help a plant produce seeds and fruit.

B. A flower's color or scent may help attract a pollinator.

C. "Transfer" means to move something from one place to another.

D. Pollen can stick to a bee while it collects nectar.

7. Read the passage: **A Library Beyond Books**

Modern libraries lend more than printed books. Many offer audiobooks, digital magazines, computers, and internet access. Some host homework clubs, language classes, or workshops where people learn new skills. Library staff can also help visitors find reliable information, though they may guide people toward sources rather than complete research for them. Because community needs differ, libraries often ask residents what services would be useful. A library is therefore both a collection of resources and a place for learning together.

Question: Which statement best expresses the passage's main idea?

A. Some libraries offer computers, digital magazines, and audiobooks.

B. The passage lists examples and ends with a broader statement about libraries.

C. Libraries ask residents about needs so they can plan useful services.

D. Libraries support learning by providing varied resources, services, and community activities.

8. Read the passage: **A Library Beyond Books**

Modern libraries lend more than printed books. Many offer audiobooks, digital magazines, computers, and internet access. Some host homework clubs, language classes, or workshops where people learn new skills. Library staff can also help visitors find reliable information, though they may guide people toward sources rather than complete research for them. Because community needs differ, libraries often ask residents what services would be useful. A library is therefore both a collection of resources and a place for learning together.

Question: Which detail from the passage supports the main idea?

A. A person without a computer at home might use a library's computer and internet access.

B. "Reliable" means trustworthy or likely to be accurate.

C. Libraries ask residents about needs so they can plan useful services.

D. Some libraries offer computers, digital magazines, and audiobooks.

9. Read the passage: **Why We Have Time Zones**

The Sun does not appear at its highest point in the sky at the same moment everywhere on Earth. As Earth rotates, different places face the Sun at different times. If every town used the exact same clock time, noon could occur while the Sun was low in the sky in some places. Time zones divide the world into regions that generally share a clock time. Their borders do not always follow straight lines because countries may adjust them for travel, trade, or government needs.

Question: Which statement best expresses the passage's main idea?

A. Time zones help places coordinate clocks with Earth's rotation and local daylight.

B. The passage explains the reason for time zones and then describes how their borders work.

C. Different places face the Sun at different times as Earth rotates.

D. Time-zone borders may bend because countries adjust them for practical reasons.

10. Read the passage: **Why We Have Time Zones**

The Sun does not appear at its highest point in the sky at the same moment everywhere on Earth. As Earth rotates, different places face the Sun at different times. If every town used the exact same clock time, noon could occur while the Sun was low in the sky in some places. Time zones divide the world into regions that generally share a clock time. Their borders do not always follow straight lines because countries may adjust them for travel, trade, or government needs.

Question: Which detail from the passage supports the main idea?

A. Different places face the Sun at different times as Earth rotates.

B. "Coordinate" means to arrange things so they work together.

C. Two towns far apart may show different clock times even at the same instant.

D. Time-zone borders may bend because countries adjust them for practical reasons.

11. Read the passage: **The Work of a Weather Station**

A weather station gathers information about conditions in the air and on the ground. Instruments can measure temperature, wind speed, rainfall, and air pressure. Forecasters compare readings from many stations with satellite images and computer models. A single measurement cannot describe the weather everywhere, and instruments must be checked to keep readings dependable. These observations help people prepare for heat, storms, strong winds, and other changing conditions.

Question: Which statement best expresses the passage's main idea?

A. Weather stations collect measurements that help forecasters understand and predict conditions.

B. Instruments may measure temperature, wind speed, rainfall, and air pressure.

C. Instruments must be checked so their measurements remain dependable.

D. The passage names tools, explains how readings are used, and describes their value.

12. Read the passage: **The Work of a Weather Station**

A weather station gathers information about conditions in the air and on the ground. Instruments can measure temperature, wind speed, rainfall, and air pressure. Forecasters compare readings from many stations with satellite images and computer models. A single measurement cannot describe the weather everywhere, and instruments must be checked to keep readings dependable. These observations help people prepare for heat, storms, strong winds, and other changing conditions.

Question: Which detail from the passage supports the main idea?

A. "Observations" means information gathered by watching or measuring.

B. Instruments may measure temperature, wind speed, rainfall, and air pressure.

C. Forecasters need information from more than one station to understand a wide region.

D. Instruments must be checked so their measurements remain dependable.

13. Read the passage: **How Bridges Stay Up**

A bridge must carry its own weight as well as the weight of people, vehicles, and sometimes trains. Engineers study the materials, the distance between supports, and the forces that act on a bridge. Some designs use arches that push weight toward strong supports. Others use cables to carry loads across long distances. Engineers also inspect bridges for cracks, rust, and damage after severe weather. Regular inspection can reveal problems before they become dangerous.

Question: Which statement best expresses the passage's main idea?

A. The passage describes design choices and then explains maintenance.

B. Bridge design and regular inspection help structures carry loads safely.

C. Inspections can reveal damage before it becomes dangerous.

D. Engineers consider materials, support distances, and forces when designing bridges.

14. Read the passage: **How Bridges Stay Up**

A bridge must carry its own weight as well as the weight of people, vehicles, and sometimes trains. Engineers study the materials, the distance between supports, and the forces that act on a bridge. Some designs use arches that push weight toward strong supports. Others use cables to carry loads across long distances. Engineers also inspect bridges for cracks, rust, and damage after severe weather. Regular inspection can reveal problems before they become dangerous.

Question: Which detail from the passage supports the main idea?

A. A bridge with long distances between supports may need a design that carries loads across those distances.

B. Engineers consider materials, support distances, and forces when designing bridges.

C. Inspections can reveal damage before it becomes dangerous.

D. "Loads" means weights or forces carried by a structure.

15. Read the passage: **The Life of a Monarch Butterfly**

Some monarch butterflies travel hundreds or thousands of miles during migration. In parts of North America, generations of monarchs move between breeding areas and warmer wintering locations. No single butterfly completes every part of the round trip. The journey depends on weather, food plants, and places to rest. Milkweed is especially important because monarch caterpillars feed on its leaves. Protecting milkweed and flowering plants can help provide food along the route.

Question: Which statement best expresses the passage's main idea?

A. The passage describes migration and identifies conditions that support it.

B. Protecting milkweed and flowering plants helps provide food for monarchs.

C. Monarch caterpillars feed on milkweed leaves.

D. Monarch migration is a multigenerational journey that depends on suitable food and resting places.

16. Read the passage: **The Life of a Monarch Butterfly**

Some monarch butterflies travel hundreds or thousands of miles during migration. In parts of North America, generations of monarchs move between breeding areas and warmer wintering locations. No single butterfly completes every part of the round trip. The journey depends on weather, food plants, and places to rest. Milkweed is especially important because monarch caterpillars feed on its leaves. Protecting milkweed and flowering plants can help provide food along the route.

Question: Which detail from the passage supports the main idea?

A. "Migration" means seasonal movement from one region to another.

B. Protecting milkweed and flowering plants helps provide food for monarchs.

C. Monarch caterpillars feed on milkweed leaves.

D. Removing all milkweed from an area could make it harder for monarchs to reproduce.

17. Read the passage: **From Seed to Seedling**

A seed contains a young plant and stored food. When it receives enough water, oxygen, and suitable warmth, germination may begin. The seed coat softens or splits, and a root usually grows downward. A shoot grows upward toward light. Not every seed sprouts; some are damaged, too old, or in conditions that do not meet their needs. Gardeners can improve the chances of growth by using healthy seeds and keeping soil conditions suitable.

Question: Which statement best expresses the passage's main idea?

A. A root usually grows downward while a shoot grows upward toward light.

B. Seeds germinate when conditions allow the young plant to begin growing.

C. Seeds may fail to sprout if they are damaged or conditions are unsuitable.

D. The passage describes steps in seed growth and conditions that affect success.

18. Read the passage: **From Seed to Seedling**

A seed contains a young plant and stored food. When it receives enough water, oxygen, and suitable warmth, germination may begin. The seed coat softens or splits, and a root usually grows downward. A shoot grows upward toward light. Not every seed sprouts; some are damaged, too old, or in conditions that do not meet their needs. Gardeners can improve the chances of growth by using healthy seeds and keeping soil conditions suitable.

Question: Which detail from the passage supports the main idea?

A. "Germination" means the beginning of a seed's growth.

B. Seeds may fail to sprout if they are damaged or conditions are unsuitable.

C. A seed kept dry may not begin germinating even if it is healthy.

D. A root usually grows downward while a shoot grows upward toward light.

19. Read the passage: **Why Some Animals Are Nocturnal**

Nocturnal animals are active mainly at night. For some species, darkness offers a way to avoid daytime heat or certain predators. Other animals find food more easily when their prey is active after sunset. These animals may have adaptations such as large eyes, sensitive hearing, or a strong sense of smell. Not every night-active animal has all these traits, and being nocturnal does not mean an animal can see perfectly in total darkness.

Question: Which statement best expresses the passage's main idea?

A. Some animals are active at night because it helps them find food or avoid difficult daytime conditions.

B. Night activity can help some species avoid daytime heat or predators.

C. Nocturnal animals may have large eyes, sensitive hearing, or a strong sense of smell.

D. The passage gives reasons for nocturnal behavior and examples of adaptations.

20. Read the passage: **Why Some Animals Are Nocturnal**

Nocturnal animals are active mainly at night. For some species, darkness offers a way to avoid daytime heat or certain predators. Other animals find food more easily when their prey is active after sunset. These animals may have adaptations such as large eyes, sensitive hearing, or a strong sense of smell. Not every night-active animal has all these traits, and being nocturnal does not mean an animal can see perfectly in total darkness.

Question: Which detail from the passage supports the main idea?

A. An animal that hunts prey active after sunset may benefit from being nocturnal.

B. Night activity can help some species avoid daytime heat or predators.

C. Nocturnal animals may have large eyes, sensitive hearing, or a strong sense of smell.

D. "Adaptations" are features or behaviors that help organisms survive.

21. Read the passage: **How a Newspaper Is Made**

A newspaper article often begins with reporting: a journalist gathers facts, interviews people, and checks documents. The writer then organizes the information so readers can understand what happened and why it matters. An editor may check clarity, accuracy, grammar, and fairness. Headlines summarize the main point in a few words, while photographs and captions can add context. Responsible newsrooms correct significant errors when they discover them.

Question: Which statement best expresses the passage's main idea?

A. The passage follows the stages of creating and reviewing a news article.

B. Editors review articles to improve clarity, accuracy, grammar, and fairness.

C. Journalists may interview people and check documents before writing.

D. Producing a newspaper article involves gathering facts, writing, editing, and presenting information clearly.

22. Read the passage: **How a Newspaper Is Made**

A newspaper article often begins with reporting: a journalist gathers facts, interviews people, and checks documents. The writer then organizes the information so readers can understand what happened and why it matters. An editor may check clarity, accuracy, grammar, and fairness. Headlines summarize the main point in a few words, while photographs and captions can add context. Responsible newsrooms correct significant errors when they discover them.

Question: Which detail from the passage supports the main idea?

A. Editors review articles to improve clarity, accuracy, grammar, and fairness.

B. A journalist should verify a surprising claim before publishing it.

C. "Context" means information that helps explain the meaning or situation.

D. Journalists may interview people and check documents before writing.

23. Read the passage: **What Makes Soil Healthy?**

Healthy soil contains mineral particles, air, water, and decayed material from living things. Earthworms and tiny organisms break down dead leaves and other remains, helping return nutrients to the soil. Plant roots need spaces in the soil where air and water can move. Soil that is packed too tightly may make root growth difficult. Gardeners can protect soil by adding compost, limiting unnecessary digging, and keeping the ground covered when possible.

Question: Which statement best expresses the passage's main idea?

A. Compacted soil can make it difficult for roots to grow.

B. The passage explains soil components and then suggests ways to protect soil.

C. Earthworms and tiny organisms help break down dead leaves and other remains.

D. Healthy soil supports plant growth through its materials, spaces, and living organisms.

24. Read the passage: **What Makes Soil Healthy?**

Healthy soil contains mineral particles, air, water, and decayed material from living things. Earthworms and tiny organisms break down dead leaves and other remains, helping return nutrients to the soil. Plant roots need spaces in the soil where air and water can move. Soil that is packed too tightly may make root growth difficult. Gardeners can protect soil by adding compost, limiting unnecessary digging, and keeping the ground covered when possible.

Question: Which detail from the passage supports the main idea?

A. "Nutrients" are substances organisms need to grow and stay healthy.

B. Compacted soil can make it difficult for roots to grow.

C. Adding compost may improve soil by increasing decayed organic material.

D. Earthworms and tiny organisms help break down dead leaves and other remains.

25. Read the passage: **How Maps Tell Stories**

A map is a model of a place, but it cannot show every detail. A mapmaker chooses what information to include based on the map's purpose. A road map highlights routes, while a rainfall map may use colors to show how much rain different areas receive. A legend explains symbols and colors, and a scale relates map distance to real distance. Readers should check the title, legend, and scale before drawing conclusions from a map.

Question: Which statement best expresses the passage's main idea?

A. A legend explains the symbols and colors used on a map.

B. Maps select and display information for a purpose, so readers must understand their features.

C. Mapmakers choose different information depending on the map's purpose.

D. The passage explains map features and gives advice for reading them.

26. Read the passage: **How Maps Tell Stories**

A map is a model of a place, but it cannot show every detail. A mapmaker chooses what information to include based on the map's purpose. A road map highlights routes, while a rainfall map may use colors to show how much rain different areas receive. A legend explains symbols and colors, and a scale relates map distance to real distance. Readers should check the title, legend, and scale before drawing conclusions from a map.

Question: Which detail from the passage supports the main idea?

A. Mapmakers choose different information depending on the map's purpose.

B. "Scale" shows the relationship between distance on a map and real distance.

C. A legend explains the symbols and colors used on a map.

D. A rainfall map may not be the best source for finding the quickest driving route.

27. Read the passage: **The Science of Sound**

Sound begins when an object vibrates. The vibrations travel through a material such as air, water, or a solid, reaching our ears. Sound usually travels faster through solids than through air because particles in many solids are close together. In a vacuum, where there are no particles to carry the vibrations, ordinary sound cannot travel. The loudness and pitch of a sound depend on different features of its vibrations.

Question: Which statement best expresses the passage's main idea?

A. Sound is produced by vibrations that travel through matter to the ear.

B. The passage explains how sound travels and compares different materials.

C. Sound often travels faster through solids because their particles are close together.

D. Ordinary sound cannot travel through a vacuum because there are no particles to carry it.

28. Read the passage: **The Science of Sound**

Sound begins when an object vibrates. The vibrations travel through a material such as air, water, or a solid, reaching our ears. Sound usually travels faster through solids than through air because particles in many solids are close together. In a vacuum, where there are no particles to carry the vibrations, ordinary sound cannot travel. The loudness and pitch of a sound depend on different features of its vibrations.

Question: Which detail from the passage supports the main idea?

A. A person in a vacuum without a communication device would not hear an ordinary sound from nearby.

B. Ordinary sound cannot travel through a vacuum because there are no particles to carry it.

C. Sound often travels faster through solids because their particles are close together.

D. "Vibrates" means moves back and forth quickly.

29. Read the passage: **Why Communities Build Parks**

Parks give people places to exercise, play, rest, and meet neighbors. Trees and planted areas can provide shade and homes for birds and insects. A well-planned park may include paths, sports areas, quiet benches, and accessible entrances. However, parks need maintenance: litter must be removed, equipment checked, and plants cared for. Community surveys can help planners learn which features residents use and what improvements are needed.

Question: Which statement best expresses the passage's main idea?

A. Parks offer recreation and nature, and thoughtful planning and maintenance help them serve a community.

B. Parks may include paths, sports areas, quiet benches, and accessible entrances.

C. Community surveys help planners identify useful features and needed improvements.

D. The passage lists park benefits, design features, and maintenance needs.

30. Read the passage: **Why Communities Build Parks**

Parks give people places to exercise, play, rest, and meet neighbors. Trees and planted areas can provide shade and homes for birds and insects. A well-planned park may include paths, sports areas, quiet benches, and accessible entrances. However, parks need maintenance: litter must be removed, equipment checked, and plants cared for. Community surveys can help planners learn which features residents use and what improvements are needed.

Question: Which detail from the passage supports the main idea?

A. If many residents use a park to walk, safe paths may be an important feature.

B. "Accessible" means designed so people with different needs can use it.

C. Parks may include paths, sports areas, quiet benches, and accessible entrances.

D. Community surveys help planners identify useful features and needed improvements.

31. Read the passage: **How Archaeologists Learn from Objects**

Archaeologists study objects and remains from past human communities. A broken pot, tool, or building foundation can provide clues about how people lived. The location of an object matters as much as the object itself because it may show how items were used together. Archaeologists record where objects are found and handle them carefully. A single object rarely answers every question, so researchers compare many clues before suggesting an explanation.

Question: Which statement best expresses the passage's main idea?

A. The location of an object can help explain how it was used.

B. Archaeologists use objects, their locations, and comparisons among clues to learn about past communities.

C. The passage explains what archaeologists study and how they interpret evidence.

D. Researchers compare many clues because one object rarely answers every question.

32. Read the passage: **How Archaeologists Learn from Objects**

Archaeologists study objects and remains from past human communities. A broken pot, tool, or building foundation can provide clues about how people lived. The location of an object matters as much as the object itself because it may show how items were used together. Archaeologists record where objects are found and handle them carefully. A single object rarely answers every question, so researchers compare many clues before suggesting an explanation.

Question: Which detail from the passage supports the main idea?

A. "Foundation" means the base that supports a building or structure.

B. Researchers compare many clues because one object rarely answers every question.

C. Finding tools beside remains of a workshop could suggest that the space was used for making things.

D. The location of an object can help explain how it was used.

33. Read the passage: **A Better Way to Save Water**

Fresh water is essential, but communities cannot use every drop of water on Earth. Much of the planet's water is salty, and some fresh water is frozen or deep underground. Homes can reduce waste by repairing leaks, taking shorter showers, and running full loads of laundry. Farms may use drip irrigation to deliver water close to plant roots. Saving water also reduces the energy needed to pump, heat, and treat it.

Question: Which statement best expresses the passage's main idea?

A. Drip irrigation delivers water close to plant roots.

B. Because usable fresh water is limited, homes and farms can save water through practical choices.

C. Saving water can also reduce the energy used to pump, heat, and treat it.

D. The passage explains why water is limited and gives examples of conservation.

34. Read the passage: **A Better Way to Save Water**

Fresh water is essential, but communities cannot use every drop of water on Earth. Much of the planet's water is salty, and some fresh water is frozen or deep underground. Homes can reduce waste by repairing leaks, taking shorter showers, and running full loads of laundry. Farms may use drip irrigation to deliver water close to plant roots. Saving water also reduces the energy needed to pump, heat, and treat it.

Question: Which detail from the passage supports the main idea?

A. Drip irrigation delivers water close to plant roots.

B. "Essential" means absolutely needed or very important.

C. A leaking tap wastes water even when no one is using it.

D. Saving water can also reduce the energy used to pump, heat, and treat it.

35. Read the passage: **How the Postal System Moves a Letter**

A letter's journey begins when it is collected from a mailbox or post office. It is sorted by destination and sent to a processing center. Machines can read many addresses, but unclear writing may require a person to help. Letters travel by truck, plane, or other transport to a facility near the destination. Local carriers then deliver them. Correct addresses and postal codes help reduce delays, though weather and other problems can still slow delivery.

Question: Which statement best expresses the passage's main idea?

A. Correct addresses and postal codes help reduce delays.

B. Unclear writing may require a person to help sort a letter.

C. The passage describes a sequence of steps from collection to delivery.

D. A letter passes through several sorting, transport, and delivery stages before reaching its destination.

36. Read the passage: **How the Postal System Moves a Letter**

A letter's journey begins when it is collected from a mailbox or post office. It is sorted by destination and sent to a processing center. Machines can read many addresses, but unclear writing may require a person to help. Letters travel by truck, plane, or other transport to a facility near the destination. Local carriers then deliver them. Correct addresses and postal codes help reduce delays, though weather and other problems can still slow delivery.

Question: Which detail from the passage supports the main idea?

A. Correct addresses and postal codes help reduce delays.

B. A letter with a missing postal code may take longer to sort.

C. Unclear writing may require a person to help sort a letter.

D. "Destination" means the place where something is going.

37. Read the passage: **Why Museums Label Their Exhibits**

Museum labels help visitors understand what they are seeing. A label may identify an object, explain when and where it was made, and describe how it was used. Good labels use clear language and focus on details that help visitors notice something important. They may also explain that experts are still debating an object's meaning. Museum displays often combine objects, labels, images, and maps to tell a larger story.

Question: Which statement best expresses the passage's main idea?

A. Clear labels help visitors notice important details about an exhibit.

B. Museum labels provide context that helps visitors understand objects and their significance.

C. The passage describes the purpose of labels and how displays combine information.

D. A label may explain when and where an object was made and how it was used.

38. Read the passage: **Why Museums Label Their Exhibits**

Museum labels help visitors understand what they are seeing. A label may identify an object, explain when and where it was made, and describe how it was used. Good labels use clear language and focus on details that help visitors notice something important. They may also explain that experts are still debating an object's meaning. Museum displays often combine objects, labels, images, and maps to tell a larger story.

Question: Which detail from the passage supports the main idea?

A. A label that mentions disagreement among experts shows that some historical questions remain unsettled.

B. Clear labels help visitors notice important details about an exhibit.

C. A label may explain when and where an object was made and how it was used.

D. "Significance" means importance or meaning.

39. Read the passage: **The Importance of Sleep**

Sleep gives the body time to rest, and it also supports learning and memory. During sleep, the brain processes information gathered during the day. Children generally need more sleep than adults because their bodies and brains are developing. Bright screens and irregular bedtimes can make it harder for some people to fall asleep. A steady routine, a calm sleeping space, and enough time for rest can support healthy sleep habits.

Question: Which statement best expresses the passage's main idea?

A. Bright screens and irregular bedtimes can make falling asleep harder for some people.

B. During sleep, the brain processes information gathered during the day.

C. The passage explains why sleep matters and gives examples of helpful habits.

D. Sleep supports rest, learning, and development, and regular habits can make sleep easier.

40. Read the passage: **The Importance of Sleep**

Sleep gives the body time to rest, and it also supports learning and memory. During sleep, the brain processes information gathered during the day. Children generally need more sleep than adults because their bodies and brains are developing. Bright screens and irregular bedtimes can make it harder for some people to fall asleep. A steady routine, a calm sleeping space, and enough time for rest can support healthy sleep habits.

Question: Which detail from the passage supports the main idea?

A. A student who regularly sleeps too little may find it harder to focus in class.

B. "Processes" means works with or handles information.

C. During sleep, the brain processes information gathered during the day.

D. Bright screens and irregular bedtimes can make falling asleep harder for some people.

41. Read the passage: **How Wind Turbines Make Electricity**

Wind turns the blades of a turbine. The blades spin a shaft connected to equipment that helps generate electricity. Turbines are often placed where winds are strong and steady, such as open plains or offshore areas. Wind power does not require burning fuel while generating electricity, but turbines still need materials, construction, maintenance, and connections to the electrical grid. Planners also consider wildlife, nearby residents, and how much wind a location receives.

Question: Which statement best expresses the passage's main idea?

A. Wind turns turbine blades, which spin a shaft connected to generating equipment.

B. Wind turbines convert moving air into electricity, and their locations require careful planning.

C. The passage explains how turbines work and then considers planning trade-offs.

D. Planners study wind conditions because turbines work best where winds are strong and steady.

42. Read the passage: **How Wind Turbines Make Electricity**

Wind turns the blades of a turbine. The blades spin a shaft connected to equipment that helps generate electricity. Turbines are often placed where winds are strong and steady, such as open plains or offshore areas. Wind power does not require burning fuel while generating electricity, but turbines still need materials, construction, maintenance, and connections to the electrical grid. Planners also consider wildlife, nearby residents, and how much wind a location receives.

Question: Which detail from the passage supports the main idea?

A. Planners study wind conditions because turbines work best where winds are strong and steady.

B. A location with weak, unpredictable winds may be a poor choice for a wind farm.

C. "Generate" means to produce or make something.

D. Wind turns turbine blades, which spin a shaft connected to generating equipment.

43. Read the passage: **What a Census Can Reveal**

A census is an organized count of the people living in a place. Governments use census information to understand population size and changes, such as where communities are growing. These data can help guide decisions about schools, roads, health services, and public resources. To be useful, a census needs broad participation and careful handling of information. Census results describe groups and communities; they do not explain every detail about an individual person.

Question: Which statement best expresses the passage's main idea?

A. The passage defines a census and explains its uses and limits.

B. Census data can guide decisions about schools, roads, and health services.

C. Broad participation helps a census provide a more complete picture of a population.

D. Census information helps communities understand population patterns and plan public services.

44. Read the passage: **What a Census Can Reveal**

A census is an organized count of the people living in a place. Governments use census information to understand population size and changes, such as where communities are growing. These data can help guide decisions about schools, roads, health services, and public resources. To be useful, a census needs broad participation and careful handling of information. Census results describe groups and communities; they do not explain every detail about an individual person.

Question: Which detail from the passage supports the main idea?

A. A rapidly growing town may use census data when planning whether it needs another school.

B. "Participation" means taking part in an activity.

C. Census data can guide decisions about schools, roads, and health services.

D. Broad participation helps a census provide a more complete picture of a population.

45. Read the passage: **Why Some Rocks Have Layers**

Sedimentary rocks can form when sand, mud, and other small particles settle in layers. Over long periods, additional layers may press down on the material below. Minerals can help bind the particles together, turning loose sediment into rock. The layers may preserve clues about earlier environments, such as rivers, lakes, or ancient seas. Wind, water, and movement of Earth's crust can later expose or tilt these layers, so scientists study their arrangement carefully.

Question: Which statement best expresses the passage's main idea?

A. Minerals can bind sediment particles together as rock forms.

B. Additional layers press down on material below, helping compact it over time.

C. Sedimentary rocks form from layers of material and can preserve clues about past environments.

D. The passage describes rock formation and explains what layers can reveal.

46. Read the passage: **Why Some Rocks Have Layers**

Sedimentary rocks can form when sand, mud, and other small particles settle in layers. Over long periods, additional layers may press down on the material below. Minerals can help bind the particles together, turning loose sediment into rock. The layers may preserve clues about earlier environments, such as rivers, lakes, or ancient seas. Wind, water, and movement of Earth's crust can later expose or tilt these layers, so scientists study their arrangement carefully.

Question: Which detail from the passage supports the main idea?

A. "Preserve" means to keep something from being lost or destroyed.

B. Additional layers press down on material below, helping compact it over time.

C. Minerals can bind sediment particles together as rock forms.

D. A layer containing tiny sea-shell remains may suggest that the area once had a marine environment.

47. Read the passage: **How Public Transportation Helps**

Buses and trains can move many people using fewer vehicles than if everyone traveled separately by car. When routes are reliable and stops are convenient, public transportation can help people reach jobs, schools, shops, and services. It can also reduce road congestion, although crowded routes may need more vehicles or better schedules. Planning a transit system requires studying where people travel, when they travel, and whether stations and vehicles are accessible.

Question: Which statement best expresses the passage's main idea?

A. Reliable routes and convenient stops make public transportation more useful.

B. Transit planners study where and when people travel.

C. The passage describes benefits and then explains factors in effective planning.

D. Public transportation can connect people and reduce some traffic problems when it is planned well.

48. Read the passage: **How Public Transportation Helps**

Buses and trains can move many people using fewer vehicles than if everyone traveled separately by car. When routes are reliable and stops are convenient, public transportation can help people reach jobs, schools, shops, and services. It can also reduce road congestion, although crowded routes may need more vehicles or better schedules. Planning a transit system requires studying where people travel, when they travel, and whether stations and vehicles are accessible.

Question: Which detail from the passage supports the main idea?

A. Reliable routes and convenient stops make public transportation more useful.

B. Transit planners study where and when people travel.

C. A bus route that does not run when workers finish their shifts may not meet their needs.

D. "Congestion" means overcrowding or a condition in which movement is slowed.

49. Read the passage: **The Role of a Food Chain**

A food chain shows how energy moves from one organism to another as organisms eat. In a grassland, grass may be eaten by a grasshopper, which may be eaten by a frog, which may be eaten by a snake. Plants usually begin these chains because they use sunlight to make their own food. Real ecosystems contain many connected food chains, so a change in one population can affect several others.

Question: Which statement best expresses the passage's main idea?

A. The passage gives a simple example and then broadens the idea to ecosystems.

B. Food chains show energy moving among organisms, and connected chains make ecosystems interdependent.

C. Plants use sunlight to make their own food and often begin food chains.

D. A change in one population can affect other organisms connected to it.

50. Read the passage: **The Role of a Food Chain**

A food chain shows how energy moves from one organism to another as organisms eat. In a grassland, grass may be eaten by a grasshopper, which may be eaten by a frog, which may be eaten by a snake. Plants usually begin these chains because they use sunlight to make their own food. Real ecosystems contain many connected food chains, so a change in one population can affect several others.

Question: Which detail from the passage supports the main idea?

A. Plants use sunlight to make their own food and often begin food chains.

B. If grass became scarce, grasshoppers might have less food, affecting animals that eat them.

C. "Population" means a group of organisms of the same kind living in an area.

D. A change in one population can affect other organisms connected to it.

Medium Questions (50)

1. Read the passage: **Why City Trees Matter**

On a hot summer day, a street with trees can feel cooler than a street covered only with pavement. Leaves provide shade, and water released from leaves cools the surrounding air. Tree roots also help rain soak into the ground instead of rushing into drains. However, city trees need care: young trees must be watered, damaged branches should be removed, and roots need enough room to grow. Neighborhoods that plan carefully can choose trees suited to local weather and streets.

Question: What can the reader reasonably infer from the passage?

A. City trees provide shade, cool the air, and help manage rain, but they need thoughtful care.

B. A city should consider its climate and available space before choosing street trees.

C. Leaves provide shade and release water, which helps make nearby air cooler.

D. Tree roots help rain soak into the ground instead of rushing into drains.

2. Read the passage: **Why City Trees Matter**

On a hot summer day, a street with trees can feel cooler than a street covered only with pavement. Leaves provide shade, and water released from leaves cools the surrounding air. Tree roots also help rain soak into the ground instead of rushing into drains. However, city trees need care: young trees must be watered, damaged branches should be removed, and roots need enough room to grow. Neighborhoods that plan carefully can choose trees suited to local weather and streets.

Question: Which text structure best describes how the author develops the ideas?

A. It explains a problem and describes possible ways to address it.

B. It compares two subjects by explaining similarities and differences.

C. It presents events in the order they happened.

D. The passage explains benefits first and then describes care trees require.

3. Read the passage: **The Journey of a Plastic Bottle**

After a plastic bottle is placed in a recycling bin, it is collected and taken to a sorting facility. Workers and machines separate plastic from paper, metal, and other materials. The bottles are then cleaned and chopped into small flakes. Those flakes may be melted and shaped into material for new products, such as clothing fibers or containers. Recycling does not make waste disappear, and not every bottle is accepted everywhere. Rinsing containers and checking local rules can help the process work better.

Question: What can the reader reasonably infer from the passage?

A. At a sorting facility, plastic is separated from paper, metal, and other materials.

B. A bottle placed in a recycling bin is not instantly turned into a new product.

C. Recycling plastic bottles involves collection, sorting, cleaning, and turning the plastic into material for new products.

D. Rinsing containers and following local rules can help recycling work more effectively.

4. Read the passage: **The Journey of a Plastic Bottle**

After a plastic bottle is placed in a recycling bin, it is collected and taken to a sorting facility. Workers and machines separate plastic from paper, metal, and other materials. The bottles are then cleaned and chopped into small flakes. Those flakes may be melted and shaped into material for new products, such as clothing fibers or containers. Recycling does not make waste disappear, and not every bottle is accepted everywhere. Rinsing containers and checking local rules can help the process work better.

Question: Which text structure best describes how the author develops the ideas?

A. It presents events in the order they happened.

B. It compares two subjects by explaining similarities and differences.

C. The passage presents the stages of a process in time order.

D. It explains a problem and describes possible ways to address it.

5. Read the passage: **How Bees Help Plants**

When a bee visits a flower to collect nectar, pollen can stick to its body. As the bee moves to another flower, some pollen may rub off. This transfer can help a plant produce seeds and, in many plants, fruit. Bees are not the only pollinators; butterflies, birds, bats, and wind can also move pollen. Different plants attract different pollinators with features such as color, scent, shape, and the time their flowers open.

Question: What can the reader reasonably infer from the passage?

A. Bees help many plants reproduce by carrying pollen from one flower to another.

B. A flower's color or scent may help attract a pollinator.

C. Pollen can stick to a bee while it collects nectar.

D. Pollen transfer can help a plant produce seeds and fruit.

6. Read the passage: **How Bees Help Plants**

When a bee visits a flower to collect nectar, pollen can stick to its body. As the bee moves to another flower, some pollen may rub off. This transfer can help a plant produce seeds and, in many plants, fruit. Bees are not the only pollinators; butterflies, birds, bats, and wind can also move pollen. Different plants attract different pollinators with features such as color, scent, shape, and the time their flowers open.

Question: Which text structure best describes how the author develops the ideas?

A. It explains a problem and describes possible ways to address it.

B. It presents events in the order they happened.

C. The passage explains a process and then gives examples of other pollinators.

D. It compares two subjects by explaining similarities and differences.

7. Read the passage: **A Library Beyond Books**

Modern libraries lend more than printed books. Many offer audiobooks, digital magazines, computers, and internet access. Some host homework clubs, language classes, or workshops where people learn new skills. Library staff can also help visitors find reliable information, though they may guide people toward sources rather than complete research for them. Because community needs differ, libraries often ask residents what services would be useful. A library is therefore both a collection of resources and a place for learning together.

Question: What can the reader reasonably infer from the passage?

A. Some libraries offer computers, digital magazines, and audiobooks.

B. A person without a computer at home might use a library's computer and internet access.

C. Libraries support learning by providing varied resources, services, and community activities.

D. Libraries ask residents about needs so they can plan useful services.

8. Read the passage: **A Library Beyond Books**

Modern libraries lend more than printed books. Many offer audiobooks, digital magazines, computers, and internet access. Some host homework clubs, language classes, or workshops where people learn new skills. Library staff can also help visitors find reliable information, though they may guide people toward sources rather than complete research for them. Because community needs differ, libraries often ask residents what services would be useful. A library is therefore both a collection of resources and a place for learning together.

Question: Which text structure best describes how the author develops the ideas?

A. It compares two subjects by explaining similarities and differences.

B. It explains a problem and describes possible ways to address it.

C. The passage lists examples and ends with a broader statement about libraries.

D. It presents events in the order they happened.

9. Read the passage: **Why We Have Time Zones**

The Sun does not appear at its highest point in the sky at the same moment everywhere on Earth. As Earth rotates, different places face the Sun at different times. If every town used the exact same clock time, noon could occur while the Sun was low in the sky in some places. Time zones divide the world into regions that generally share a clock time. Their borders do not always follow straight lines because countries may adjust them for travel, trade, or government needs.

Question: What can the reader reasonably infer from the passage?

A. Two towns far apart may show different clock times even at the same instant.

B. Time zones help places coordinate clocks with Earth's rotation and local daylight.

C. Time-zone borders may bend because countries adjust them for practical reasons.

D. Different places face the Sun at different times as Earth rotates.

10. Read the passage: **Why We Have Time Zones**

The Sun does not appear at its highest point in the sky at the same moment everywhere on Earth. As Earth rotates, different places face the Sun at different times. If every town used the exact same clock time, noon could occur while the Sun was low in the sky in some places. Time zones divide the world into regions that generally share a clock time. Their borders do not always follow straight lines because countries may adjust them for travel, trade, or government needs.

Question: Which text structure best describes how the author develops the ideas?

A. It explains a problem and describes possible ways to address it.

B. The passage explains the reason for time zones and then describes how their borders work.

C. It presents events in the order they happened.

D. It compares two subjects by explaining similarities and differences.

11. Read the passage: **The Work of a Weather Station**

A weather station gathers information about conditions in the air and on the ground. Instruments can measure temperature, wind speed, rainfall, and air pressure. Forecasters compare readings from many stations with satellite images and computer models. A single measurement cannot describe the weather everywhere, and instruments must be checked to keep readings dependable. These observations help people prepare for heat, storms, strong winds, and other changing conditions.

Question: What can the reader reasonably infer from the passage?

A. Instruments must be checked so their measurements remain dependable.

B. Weather stations collect measurements that help forecasters understand and predict conditions.

C. Instruments may measure temperature, wind speed, rainfall, and air pressure.

D. Forecasters need information from more than one station to understand a wide region.

12. Read the passage: **The Work of a Weather Station**

A weather station gathers information about conditions in the air and on the ground. Instruments can measure temperature, wind speed, rainfall, and air pressure. Forecasters compare readings from many stations with satellite images and computer models. A single measurement cannot describe the weather everywhere, and instruments must be checked to keep readings dependable. These observations help people prepare for heat, storms, strong winds, and other changing conditions.

Question: Which text structure best describes how the author develops the ideas?

A. It presents events in the order they happened.

B. It explains a problem and describes possible ways to address it.

C. The passage names tools, explains how readings are used, and describes their value.

D. It compares two subjects by explaining similarities and differences.

13. Read the passage: **How Bridges Stay Up**

A bridge must carry its own weight as well as the weight of people, vehicles, and sometimes trains. Engineers study the materials, the distance between supports, and the forces that act on a bridge. Some designs use arches that push weight toward strong supports. Others use cables to carry loads across long distances. Engineers also inspect bridges for cracks, rust, and damage after severe weather. Regular inspection can reveal problems before they become dangerous.

Question: What can the reader reasonably infer from the passage?

A. Engineers consider materials, support distances, and forces when designing bridges.

B. Inspections can reveal damage before it becomes dangerous.

C. Bridge design and regular inspection help structures carry loads safely.

D. A bridge with long distances between supports may need a design that carries loads across those distances.

14. Read the passage: **How Bridges Stay Up**

A bridge must carry its own weight as well as the weight of people, vehicles, and sometimes trains. Engineers study the materials, the distance between supports, and the forces that act on a bridge. Some designs use arches that push weight toward strong supports. Others use cables to carry loads across long distances. Engineers also inspect bridges for cracks, rust, and damage after severe weather. Regular inspection can reveal problems before they become dangerous.

Question: Which text structure best describes how the author develops the ideas?

A. It explains a problem and describes possible ways to address it.

B. The passage describes design choices and then explains maintenance.

C. It compares two subjects by explaining similarities and differences.

D. It presents events in the order they happened.

15. Read the passage: **The Life of a Monarch Butterfly**

Some monarch butterflies travel hundreds or thousands of miles during migration. In parts of North America, generations of monarchs move between breeding areas and warmer wintering locations. No single butterfly completes every part of the round trip. The journey depends on weather, food plants, and places to rest. Milkweed is especially important because monarch caterpillars feed on its leaves. Protecting milkweed and flowering plants can help provide food along the route.

Question: What can the reader reasonably infer from the passage?

A. Monarch migration is a multigenerational journey that depends on suitable food and resting places.

B. Monarch caterpillars feed on milkweed leaves.

C. Protecting milkweed and flowering plants helps provide food for monarchs.

D. Removing all milkweed from an area could make it harder for monarchs to reproduce.

16. Read the passage: **The Life of a Monarch Butterfly**

Some monarch butterflies travel hundreds or thousands of miles during migration. In parts of North America, generations of monarchs move between breeding areas and warmer wintering locations. No single butterfly completes every part of the round trip. The journey depends on weather, food plants, and places to rest. Milkweed is especially important because monarch caterpillars feed on its leaves. Protecting milkweed and flowering plants can help provide food along the route.

Question: Which text structure best describes how the author develops the ideas?

A. It compares two subjects by explaining similarities and differences.

B. It explains a problem and describes possible ways to address it.

C. It presents events in the order they happened.

D. The passage describes migration and identifies conditions that support it.

17. Read the passage: **From Seed to Seedling**

A seed contains a young plant and stored food. When it receives enough water, oxygen, and suitable warmth, germination may begin. The seed coat softens or splits, and a root usually grows downward. A shoot grows upward toward light. Not every seed sprouts; some are damaged, too old, or in conditions that do not meet their needs. Gardeners can improve the chances of growth by using healthy seeds and keeping soil conditions suitable.

Question: What can the reader reasonably infer from the passage?

A. A root usually grows downward while a shoot grows upward toward light.

B. A seed kept dry may not begin germinating even if it is healthy.

C. Seeds may fail to sprout if they are damaged or conditions are unsuitable.

D. Seeds germinate when conditions allow the young plant to begin growing.

18. Read the passage: **From Seed to Seedling**

A seed contains a young plant and stored food. When it receives enough water, oxygen, and suitable warmth, germination may begin. The seed coat softens or splits, and a root usually grows downward. A shoot grows upward toward light. Not every seed sprouts; some are damaged, too old, or in conditions that do not meet their needs. Gardeners can improve the chances of growth by using healthy seeds and keeping soil conditions suitable.

Question: Which text structure best describes how the author develops the ideas?

A. It explains a problem and describes possible ways to address it.

B. It presents events in the order they happened.

C. It compares two subjects by explaining similarities and differences.

D. The passage describes steps in seed growth and conditions that affect success.

19. Read the passage: **Why Some Animals Are Nocturnal**

Nocturnal animals are active mainly at night. For some species, darkness offers a way to avoid daytime heat or certain predators. Other animals find food more easily when their prey is active after sunset. These animals may have adaptations such as large eyes, sensitive hearing, or a strong sense of smell. Not every night-active animal has all these traits, and being nocturnal does not mean an animal can see perfectly in total darkness.

Question: What can the reader reasonably infer from the passage?

A. Some animals are active at night because it helps them find food or avoid difficult daytime conditions.

B. An animal that hunts prey active after sunset may benefit from being nocturnal.

C. Nocturnal animals may have large eyes, sensitive hearing, or a strong sense of smell.

D. Night activity can help some species avoid daytime heat or predators.

20. Read the passage: **Why Some Animals Are Nocturnal**

Nocturnal animals are active mainly at night. For some species, darkness offers a way to avoid daytime heat or certain predators. Other animals find food more easily when their prey is active after sunset. These animals may have adaptations such as large eyes, sensitive hearing, or a strong sense of smell. Not every night-active animal has all these traits, and being nocturnal does not mean an animal can see perfectly in total darkness.

Question: Which text structure best describes how the author develops the ideas?

A. It compares two subjects by explaining similarities and differences.

B. It explains a problem and describes possible ways to address it.

C. The passage gives reasons for nocturnal behavior and examples of adaptations.

D. It presents events in the order they happened.

21. Read the passage: **How a Newspaper Is Made**

A newspaper article often begins with reporting: a journalist gathers facts, interviews people, and checks documents. The writer then organizes the information so readers can understand what happened and why it matters. An editor may check clarity, accuracy, grammar, and fairness. Headlines summarize the main point in a few words, while photographs and captions can add context. Responsible newsrooms correct significant errors when they discover them.

Question: What can the reader reasonably infer from the passage?

A. A journalist should verify a surprising claim before publishing it.

B. Producing a newspaper article involves gathering facts, writing, editing, and presenting information clearly.

C. Journalists may interview people and check documents before writing.

D. Editors review articles to improve clarity, accuracy, grammar, and fairness.

22. Read the passage: **How a Newspaper Is Made**

A newspaper article often begins with reporting: a journalist gathers facts, interviews people, and checks documents. The writer then organizes the information so readers can understand what happened and why it matters. An editor may check clarity, accuracy, grammar, and fairness. Headlines summarize the main point in a few words, while photographs and captions can add context. Responsible newsrooms correct significant errors when they discover them.

Question: Which text structure best describes how the author develops the ideas?

A. It explains a problem and describes possible ways to address it.

B. It compares two subjects by explaining similarities and differences.

C. The passage follows the stages of creating and reviewing a news article.

D. It presents events in the order they happened.

23. Read the passage: **What Makes Soil Healthy?**

Healthy soil contains mineral particles, air, water, and decayed material from living things. Earthworms and tiny organisms break down dead leaves and other remains, helping return nutrients to the soil. Plant roots need spaces in the soil where air and water can move. Soil that is packed too tightly may make root growth difficult. Gardeners can protect soil by adding compost, limiting unnecessary digging, and keeping the ground covered when possible.

Question: What can the reader reasonably infer from the passage?

A. Adding compost may improve soil by increasing decayed organic material.

B. Earthworms and tiny organisms help break down dead leaves and other remains.

C. Healthy soil supports plant growth through its materials, spaces, and living organisms.

D. Compacted soil can make it difficult for roots to grow.

24. Read the passage: **What Makes Soil Healthy?**

Healthy soil contains mineral particles, air, water, and decayed material from living things. Earthworms and tiny organisms break down dead leaves and other remains, helping return nutrients to the soil. Plant roots need spaces in the soil where air and water can move. Soil that is packed too tightly may make root growth difficult. Gardeners can protect soil by adding compost, limiting unnecessary digging, and keeping the ground covered when possible.

Question: Which text structure best describes how the author develops the ideas?

A. It explains a problem and describes possible ways to address it.

B. The passage explains soil components and then suggests ways to protect soil.

C. It presents events in the order they happened.

D. It compares two subjects by explaining similarities and differences.

25. Read the passage: **How Maps Tell Stories**

A map is a model of a place, but it cannot show every detail. A mapmaker chooses what information to include based on the map's purpose. A road map highlights routes, while a rainfall map may use colors to show how much rain different areas receive. A legend explains symbols and colors, and a scale relates map distance to real distance. Readers should check the title, legend, and scale before drawing conclusions from a map.

Question: What can the reader reasonably infer from the passage?

A. Mapmakers choose different information depending on the map's purpose.

B. A rainfall map may not be the best source for finding the quickest driving route.

C. A legend explains the symbols and colors used on a map.

D. Maps select and display information for a purpose, so readers must understand their features.

26. Read the passage: **How Maps Tell Stories**

A map is a model of a place, but it cannot show every detail. A mapmaker chooses what information to include based on the map's purpose. A road map highlights routes, while a rainfall map may use colors to show how much rain different areas receive. A legend explains symbols and colors, and a scale relates map distance to real distance. Readers should check the title, legend, and scale before drawing conclusions from a map.

Question: Which text structure best describes how the author develops the ideas?

A. It compares two subjects by explaining similarities and differences.

B. It explains a problem and describes possible ways to address it.

C. The passage explains map features and gives advice for reading them.

D. It presents events in the order they happened.

27. Read the passage: **The Science of Sound**

Sound begins when an object vibrates. The vibrations travel through a material such as air, water, or a solid, reaching our ears. Sound usually travels faster through solids than through air because particles in many solids are close together. In a vacuum, where there are no particles to carry the vibrations, ordinary sound cannot travel. The loudness and pitch of a sound depend on different features of its vibrations.

Question: What can the reader reasonably infer from the passage?

A. Sound is produced by vibrations that travel through matter to the ear.

B. A person in a vacuum without a communication device would not hear an ordinary sound from nearby.

C. Sound often travels faster through solids because their particles are close together.

D. Ordinary sound cannot travel through a vacuum because there are no particles to carry it.

28. Read the passage: **The Science of Sound**

Sound begins when an object vibrates. The vibrations travel through a material such as air, water, or a solid, reaching our ears. Sound usually travels faster through solids than through air because particles in many solids are close together. In a vacuum, where there are no particles to carry the vibrations, ordinary sound cannot travel. The loudness and pitch of a sound depend on different features of its vibrations.

Question: Which text structure best describes how the author develops the ideas?

A. It explains a problem and describes possible ways to address it.

B. It compares two subjects by explaining similarities and differences.

C. The passage explains how sound travels and compares different materials.

D. It presents events in the order they happened.

29. Read the passage: **Why Communities Build Parks**

Parks give people places to exercise, play, rest, and meet neighbors. Trees and planted areas can provide shade and homes for birds and insects. A well-planned park may include paths, sports areas, quiet benches, and accessible entrances. However, parks need maintenance: litter must be removed, equipment checked, and plants cared for. Community surveys can help planners learn which features residents use and what improvements are needed.

Question: What can the reader reasonably infer from the passage?

A. Parks offer recreation and nature, and thoughtful planning and maintenance help them serve a community.

B. Parks may include paths, sports areas, quiet benches, and accessible entrances.

C. If many residents use a park to walk, safe paths may be an important feature.

D. Community surveys help planners identify useful features and needed improvements.

30. Read the passage: **Why Communities Build Parks**

Parks give people places to exercise, play, rest, and meet neighbors. Trees and planted areas can provide shade and homes for birds and insects. A well-planned park may include paths, sports areas, quiet benches, and accessible entrances. However, parks need maintenance: litter must be removed, equipment checked, and plants cared for. Community surveys can help planners learn which features residents use and what improvements are needed.

Question: Which text structure best describes how the author develops the ideas?

A. It explains a problem and describes possible ways to address it.

B. It compares two subjects by explaining similarities and differences.

C. It presents events in the order they happened.

D. The passage lists park benefits, design features, and maintenance needs.

31. Read the passage: **How Archaeologists Learn from Objects**

Archaeologists study objects and remains from past human communities. A broken pot, tool, or building foundation can provide clues about how people lived. The location of an object matters as much as the object itself because it may show how items were used together. Archaeologists record where objects are found and handle them carefully. A single object rarely answers every question, so researchers compare many clues before suggesting an explanation.

Question: What can the reader reasonably infer from the passage?

A. The location of an object can help explain how it was used.

B. Researchers compare many clues because one object rarely answers every question.

C. Finding tools beside remains of a workshop could suggest that the space was used for making things.

D. Archaeologists use objects, their locations, and comparisons among clues to learn about past communities.

32. Read the passage: **How Archaeologists Learn from Objects**

Archaeologists study objects and remains from past human communities. A broken pot, tool, or building foundation can provide clues about how people lived. The location of an object matters as much as the object itself because it may show how items were used together. Archaeologists record where objects are found and handle them carefully. A single object rarely answers every question, so researchers compare many clues before suggesting an explanation.

Question: Which text structure best describes how the author develops the ideas?

A. It presents events in the order they happened.

B. The passage explains what archaeologists study and how they interpret evidence.

C. It compares two subjects by explaining similarities and differences.

D. It explains a problem and describes possible ways to address it.

33. Read the passage: **A Better Way to Save Water**

Fresh water is essential, but communities cannot use every drop of water on Earth. Much of the planet's water is salty, and some fresh water is frozen or deep underground. Homes can reduce waste by repairing leaks, taking shorter showers, and running full loads of laundry. Farms may use drip irrigation to deliver water close to plant roots. Saving water also reduces the energy needed to pump, heat, and treat it.

Question: What can the reader reasonably infer from the passage?

A. Drip irrigation delivers water close to plant roots.

B. Because usable fresh water is limited, homes and farms can save water through practical choices.

C. A leaking tap wastes water even when no one is using it.

D. Saving water can also reduce the energy used to pump, heat, and treat it.

34. Read the passage: **A Better Way to Save Water**

Fresh water is essential, but communities cannot use every drop of water on Earth. Much of the planet's water is salty, and some fresh water is frozen or deep underground. Homes can reduce waste by repairing leaks, taking shorter showers, and running full loads of laundry. Farms may use drip irrigation to deliver water close to plant roots. Saving water also reduces the energy needed to pump, heat, and treat it.

Question: Which text structure best describes how the author develops the ideas?

A. It compares two subjects by explaining similarities and differences.

B. It presents events in the order they happened.

C. It explains a problem and describes possible ways to address it.

D. The passage explains why water is limited and gives examples of conservation.

35. Read the passage: **How the Postal System Moves a Letter**

A letter's journey begins when it is collected from a mailbox or post office. It is sorted by destination and sent to a processing center. Machines can read many addresses, but unclear writing may require a person to help. Letters travel by truck, plane, or other transport to a facility near the destination. Local carriers then deliver them. Correct addresses and postal codes help reduce delays, though weather and other problems can still slow delivery.

Question: What can the reader reasonably infer from the passage?

A. Correct addresses and postal codes help reduce delays.

B. A letter passes through several sorting, transport, and delivery stages before reaching its destination.

C. A letter with a missing postal code may take longer to sort.

D. Unclear writing may require a person to help sort a letter.

36. Read the passage: **How the Postal System Moves a Letter**

A letter's journey begins when it is collected from a mailbox or post office. It is sorted by destination and sent to a processing center. Machines can read many addresses, but unclear writing may require a person to help. Letters travel by truck, plane, or other transport to a facility near the destination. Local carriers then deliver them. Correct addresses and postal codes help reduce delays, though weather and other problems can still slow delivery.

Question: Which text structure best describes how the author develops the ideas?

A. It presents events in the order they happened.

B. It explains a problem and describes possible ways to address it.

C. The passage describes a sequence of steps from collection to delivery.

D. It compares two subjects by explaining similarities and differences.

37. Read the passage: **Why Museums Label Their Exhibits**

Museum labels help visitors understand what they are seeing. A label may identify an object, explain when and where it was made, and describe how it was used. Good labels use clear language and focus on details that help visitors notice something important. They may also explain that experts are still debating an object's meaning. Museum displays often combine objects, labels, images, and maps to tell a larger story.

Question: What can the reader reasonably infer from the passage?

A. Clear labels help visitors notice important details about an exhibit.

B. A label may explain when and where an object was made and how it was used.

C. Museum labels provide context that helps visitors understand objects and their significance.

D. A label that mentions disagreement among experts shows that some historical questions remain unsettled.

38. Read the passage: **Why Museums Label Their Exhibits**

Museum labels help visitors understand what they are seeing. A label may identify an object, explain when and where it was made, and describe how it was used. Good labels use clear language and focus on details that help visitors notice something important. They may also explain that experts are still debating an object's meaning. Museum displays often combine objects, labels, images, and maps to tell a larger story.

Question: Which text structure best describes how the author develops the ideas?

A. It presents events in the order they happened.

B. It compares two subjects by explaining similarities and differences.

C. The passage describes the purpose of labels and how displays combine information.

D. It explains a problem and describes possible ways to address it.

39. Read the passage: **The Importance of Sleep**

Sleep gives the body time to rest, and it also supports learning and memory. During sleep, the brain processes information gathered during the day. Children generally need more sleep than adults because their bodies and brains are developing. Bright screens and irregular bedtimes can make it harder for some people to fall asleep. A steady routine, a calm sleeping space, and enough time for rest can support healthy sleep habits.

Question: What can the reader reasonably infer from the passage?

A. During sleep, the brain processes information gathered during the day.

B. Bright screens and irregular bedtimes can make falling asleep harder for some people.

C. A student who regularly sleeps too little may find it harder to focus in class.

D. Sleep supports rest, learning, and development, and regular habits can make sleep easier.

40. Read the passage: **The Importance of Sleep**

Sleep gives the body time to rest, and it also supports learning and memory. During sleep, the brain processes information gathered during the day. Children generally need more sleep than adults because their bodies and brains are developing. Bright screens and irregular bedtimes can make it harder for some people to fall asleep. A steady routine, a calm sleeping space, and enough time for rest can support healthy sleep habits.

Question: Which text structure best describes how the author develops the ideas?

A. It presents events in the order they happened.

B. It explains a problem and describes possible ways to address it.

C. The passage explains why sleep matters and gives examples of helpful habits.

D. It compares two subjects by explaining similarities and differences.

41. Read the passage: **How Wind Turbines Make Electricity**

Wind turns the blades of a turbine. The blades spin a shaft connected to equipment that helps generate electricity. Turbines are often placed where winds are strong and steady, such as open plains or offshore areas. Wind power does not require burning fuel while generating electricity, but turbines still need materials, construction, maintenance, and connections to the electrical grid. Planners also consider wildlife, nearby residents, and how much wind a location receives.

Question: What can the reader reasonably infer from the passage?

A. A location with weak, unpredictable winds may be a poor choice for a wind farm.

B. Wind turbines convert moving air into electricity, and their locations require careful planning.

C. Planners study wind conditions because turbines work best where winds are strong and steady.

D. Wind turns turbine blades, which spin a shaft connected to generating equipment.

42. Read the passage: **How Wind Turbines Make Electricity**

Wind turns the blades of a turbine. The blades spin a shaft connected to equipment that helps generate electricity. Turbines are often placed where winds are strong and steady, such as open plains or offshore areas. Wind power does not require burning fuel while generating electricity, but turbines still need materials, construction, maintenance, and connections to the electrical grid. Planners also consider wildlife, nearby residents, and how much wind a location receives.

Question: Which text structure best describes how the author develops the ideas?

A. It compares two subjects by explaining similarities and differences.

B. It explains a problem and describes possible ways to address it.

C. The passage explains how turbines work and then considers planning trade-offs.

D. It presents events in the order they happened.

43. Read the passage: **What a Census Can Reveal**

A census is an organized count of the people living in a place. Governments use census information to understand population size and changes, such as where communities are growing. These data can help guide decisions about schools, roads, health services, and public resources. To be useful, a census needs broad participation and careful handling of information. Census results describe groups and communities; they do not explain every detail about an individual person.

Question: What can the reader reasonably infer from the passage?

A. Census information helps communities understand population patterns and plan public services.

B. A rapidly growing town may use census data when planning whether it needs another school.

C. Census data can guide decisions about schools, roads, and health services.

D. Broad participation helps a census provide a more complete picture of a population.

44. Read the passage: **What a Census Can Reveal**

A census is an organized count of the people living in a place. Governments use census information to understand population size and changes, such as where communities are growing. These data can help guide decisions about schools, roads, health services, and public resources. To be useful, a census needs broad participation and careful handling of information. Census results describe groups and communities; they do not explain every detail about an individual person.

Question: Which text structure best describes how the author develops the ideas?

A. It presents events in the order they happened.

B. The passage defines a census and explains its uses and limits.

C. It compares two subjects by explaining similarities and differences.

D. It explains a problem and describes possible ways to address it.

45. Read the passage: **Why Some Rocks Have Layers**

Sedimentary rocks can form when sand, mud, and other small particles settle in layers. Over long periods, additional layers may press down on the material below. Minerals can help bind the particles together, turning loose sediment into rock. The layers may preserve clues about earlier environments, such as rivers, lakes, or ancient seas. Wind, water, and movement of Earth's crust can later expose or tilt these layers, so scientists study their arrangement carefully.

Question: What can the reader reasonably infer from the passage?

A. A layer containing tiny sea-shell remains may suggest that the area once had a marine environment.

B. Minerals can bind sediment particles together as rock forms.

C. Additional layers press down on material below, helping compact it over time.

D. Sedimentary rocks form from layers of material and can preserve clues about past environments.

46. Read the passage: **Why Some Rocks Have Layers**

Sedimentary rocks can form when sand, mud, and other small particles settle in layers. Over long periods, additional layers may press down on the material below. Minerals can help bind the particles together, turning loose sediment into rock. The layers may preserve clues about earlier environments, such as rivers, lakes, or ancient seas. Wind, water, and movement of Earth's crust can later expose or tilt these layers, so scientists study their arrangement carefully.

Question: Which text structure best describes how the author develops the ideas?

A. It compares two subjects by explaining similarities and differences.

B. It explains a problem and describes possible ways to address it.

C. It presents events in the order they happened.

D. The passage describes rock formation and explains what layers can reveal.

47. Read the passage: **How Public Transportation Helps**

Buses and trains can move many people using fewer vehicles than if everyone traveled separately by car. When routes are reliable and stops are convenient, public transportation can help people reach jobs, schools, shops, and services. It can also reduce road congestion, although crowded routes may need more vehicles or better schedules. Planning a transit system requires studying where people travel, when they travel, and whether stations and vehicles are accessible.

Question: What can the reader reasonably infer from the passage?

A. A bus route that does not run when workers finish their shifts may not meet their needs.

B. Transit planners study where and when people travel.

C. Public transportation can connect people and reduce some traffic problems when it is planned well.

D. Reliable routes and convenient stops make public transportation more useful.

48. Read the passage: **How Public Transportation Helps**

Buses and trains can move many people using fewer vehicles than if everyone traveled separately by car. When routes are reliable and stops are convenient, public transportation can help people reach jobs, schools, shops, and services. It can also reduce road congestion, although crowded routes may need more vehicles or better schedules. Planning a transit system requires studying where people travel, when they travel, and whether stations and vehicles are accessible.

Question: Which text structure best describes how the author develops the ideas?

A. The passage describes benefits and then explains factors in effective planning.

B. It explains a problem and describes possible ways to address it.

C. It presents events in the order they happened.

D. It compares two subjects by explaining similarities and differences.

49. Read the passage: **The Role of a Food Chain**

A food chain shows how energy moves from one organism to another as organisms eat. In a grassland, grass may be eaten by a grasshopper, which may be eaten by a frog, which may be eaten by a snake. Plants usually begin these chains because they use sunlight to make their own food. Real ecosystems contain many connected food chains, so a change in one population can affect several others.

Question: What can the reader reasonably infer from the passage?

A. If grass became scarce, grasshoppers might have less food, affecting animals that eat them.

B. Plants use sunlight to make their own food and often begin food chains.

C. A change in one population can affect other organisms connected to it.

D. Food chains show energy moving among organisms, and connected chains make ecosystems interdependent.

50. Read the passage: **The Role of a Food Chain**

A food chain shows how energy moves from one organism to another as organisms eat. In a grassland, grass may be eaten by a grasshopper, which may be eaten by a frog, which may be eaten by a snake. Plants usually begin these chains because they use sunlight to make their own food. Real ecosystems contain many connected food chains, so a change in one population can affect several others.

Question: Which text structure best describes how the author develops the ideas?

A. It compares two subjects by explaining similarities and differences.

B. The passage gives a simple example and then broadens the idea to ecosystems.

C. It presents events in the order they happened.

D. It explains a problem and describes possible ways to address it.

Hard Questions (50)

1. Read the passage: **Why City Trees Matter**

On a hot summer day, a street with trees can feel cooler than a street covered only with pavement. Leaves provide shade, and water released from leaves cools the surrounding air. Tree roots also help rain soak into the ground instead of rushing into drains. However, city trees need care: young trees must be watered, damaged branches should be removed, and roots need enough room to grow. Neighborhoods that plan carefully can choose trees suited to local weather and streets.

Question: In the passage, what does “suited” mean?

A. well matched to a particular purpose or condition

B. works with or handles information

C. absolutely needed or very important

D. to move something from one place to another

2. Read the passage: **Why City Trees Matter**

On a hot summer day, a street with trees can feel cooler than a street covered only with pavement. Leaves provide shade, and water released from leaves cools the surrounding air. Tree roots also help rain soak into the ground instead of rushing into drains. However, city trees need care: young trees must be watered, damaged branches should be removed, and roots need enough room to grow. Neighborhoods that plan carefully can choose trees suited to local weather and streets.

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A. A city should consider its climate and available space before choosing street trees.

B. City trees provide shade, cool the air, and help manage rain, but they need thoughtful care.

C. Tree roots help rain soak into the ground instead of rushing into drains.

D. Leaves provide shade and release water, which helps make nearby air cooler.

3. Read the passage: **The Journey of a Plastic Bottle**

After a plastic bottle is placed in a recycling bin, it is collected and taken to a sorting facility. Workers and machines separate plastic from paper, metal, and other materials. The bottles are then cleaned and chopped into small flakes. Those flakes may be melted and shaped into material for new products, such as clothing fibers or containers. Recycling does not make waste disappear, and not every bottle is accepted everywhere. Rinsing containers and checking local rules can help the process work better.

Question: In the passage, what does “facility” mean?

A. a place where a particular activity is carried out

B. trustworthy or likely to be accurate

C. importance or meaning

D. information that helps explain the meaning or situation

4. Read the passage: **The Journey of a Plastic Bottle**

After a plastic bottle is placed in a recycling bin, it is collected and taken to a sorting facility. Workers and machines separate plastic from paper, metal, and other materials. The bottles are then cleaned and chopped into small flakes. Those flakes may be melted and shaped into material for new products, such as clothing fibers or containers. Recycling does not make waste disappear, and not every bottle is accepted everywhere. Rinsing containers and checking local rules can help the process work better.

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A. A bottle placed in a recycling bin is not instantly turned into a new product.

B. At a sorting facility, plastic is separated from paper, metal, and other materials.

C. Rinsing containers and following local rules can help recycling work more effectively.

D. Recycling plastic bottles involves collection, sorting, cleaning, and turning the plastic into material for new products.

5. Read the passage: **How Bees Help Plants**

When a bee visits a flower to collect nectar, pollen can stick to its body. As the bee moves to another flower, some pollen may rub off. This transfer can help a plant produce seeds and, in many plants, fruit. Bees are not the only pollinators; butterflies, birds, bats, and wind can also move pollen. Different plants attract different pollinators with features such as color, scent, shape, and the time their flowers open.

Question: In the passage, what does “Transfer” mean?

A. seasonal movement from one region to another

B. taking part in an activity

C. to move something from one place to another

D. works with or handles information

6. Read the passage: **How Bees Help Plants**

When a bee visits a flower to collect nectar, pollen can stick to its body. As the bee moves to another flower, some pollen may rub off. This transfer can help a plant produce seeds and, in many plants, fruit. Bees are not the only pollinators; butterflies, birds, bats, and wind can also move pollen. Different plants attract different pollinators with features such as color, scent, shape, and the time their flowers open.

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A. Pollen can stick to a bee while it collects nectar.

B. A flower’s color or scent may help attract a pollinator.

C. Bees help many plants reproduce by carrying pollen from one flower to another.

D. Pollen transfer can help a plant produce seeds and fruit.

7. Read the passage: **A Library Beyond Books**

Modern libraries lend more than printed books. Many offer audiobooks, digital magazines, computers, and internet access. Some host homework clubs, language classes, or workshops where people learn new skills. Library staff can also help visitors find reliable information, though they may guide people toward sources rather than complete research for them. Because community needs differ, libraries often ask residents what services would be useful. A library is therefore both a collection of resources and a place for learning together.

Question: In the passage, what does “Reliable” mean?

A. importance or meaning

B. trustworthy or likely to be accurate

C. to keep something from being lost or destroyed

D. information gathered by watching or measuring

8. Read the passage: **A Library Beyond Books**

Modern libraries lend more than printed books. Many offer audiobooks, digital magazines, computers, and internet access. Some host homework clubs, language classes, or workshops where people learn new skills. Library staff can also help visitors find reliable information, though they may guide people toward sources rather than complete research for them. Because community needs differ, libraries often ask residents what services would be useful. A library is therefore both a collection of resources and a place for learning together.

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A. Libraries ask residents about needs so they can plan useful services.

B. A person without a computer at home might use a library’s computer and internet access.

C. Some libraries offer computers, digital magazines, and audiobooks.

D. Libraries support learning by providing varied resources, services, and community activities.

9. Read the passage: **Why We Have Time Zones**

The Sun does not appear at its highest point in the sky at the same moment everywhere on Earth. As Earth rotates, different places face the Sun at different times. If every town used the exact same clock time, noon could occur while the Sun was low in the sky in some places. Time zones divide the world into regions that generally share a clock time. Their borders do not always follow straight lines because countries may adjust them for travel, trade, or government needs.

Question: In the passage, what does “Coordinate” mean?

A. a place where a particular activity is carried out

B. moves back and forth quickly

C. to arrange things so they work together

D. information gathered by watching or measuring

10. Read the passage: **Why We Have Time Zones**

The Sun does not appear at its highest point in the sky at the same moment everywhere on Earth. As Earth rotates, different places face the Sun at different times. If every town used the exact same clock time, noon could occur while the Sun was low in the sky in some places. Time zones divide the world into regions that generally share a clock time. Their borders do not always follow straight lines because countries may adjust them for travel, trade, or government needs.

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A. Two towns far apart may show different clock times even at the same instant.

B. Different places face the Sun at different times as Earth rotates.

C. Time zones help places coordinate clocks with Earth's rotation and local daylight.

D. Time-zone borders may bend because countries adjust them for practical reasons.

11. Read the passage: **The Work of a Weather Station**

A weather station gathers information about conditions in the air and on the ground. Instruments can measure temperature, wind speed, rainfall, and air pressure. Forecasters compare readings from many stations with satellite images and computer models. A single measurement cannot describe the weather everywhere, and instruments must be checked to keep readings dependable. These observations help people prepare for heat, storms, strong winds, and other changing conditions.

Question: In the passage, what does “Observations” mean?

A. to keep something from being lost or destroyed

B. trustworthy or likely to be accurate

C. well matched to a particular purpose or condition

D. information gathered by watching or measuring

12. Read the passage: **The Work of a Weather Station**

A weather station gathers information about conditions in the air and on the ground. Instruments can measure temperature, wind speed, rainfall, and air pressure. Forecasters compare readings from many stations with satellite images and computer models. A single measurement cannot describe the weather everywhere, and instruments must be checked to keep readings dependable. These observations help people prepare for heat, storms, strong winds, and other changing conditions.

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A. Instruments may measure temperature, wind speed, rainfall, and air pressure.

B. Weather stations collect measurements that help forecasters understand and predict conditions.

C. Instruments must be checked so their measurements remain dependable.

D. Forecasters need information from more than one station to understand a wide region.

13. Read the passage: **How Bridges Stay Up**

A bridge must carry its own weight as well as the weight of people, vehicles, and sometimes trains. Engineers study the materials, the distance between supports, and the forces that act on a bridge. Some designs use arches that push weight toward strong supports. Others use cables to carry loads across long distances. Engineers also inspect bridges for cracks, rust, and damage after severe weather. Regular inspection can reveal problems before they become dangerous.

Question: In the passage, what does “Loads” mean?

A. weights or forces carried by a structure

B. well matched to a particular purpose or condition

C. trustworthy or likely to be accurate

D. information gathered by watching or measuring

14. Read the passage: **How Bridges Stay Up**

A bridge must carry its own weight as well as the weight of people, vehicles, and sometimes trains. Engineers study the materials, the distance between supports, and the forces that act on a bridge. Some designs use arches that push weight toward strong supports. Others use cables to carry loads across long distances. Engineers also inspect bridges for cracks, rust, and damage after severe weather. Regular inspection can reveal problems before they become dangerous.

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A. A bridge with long distances between supports may need a design that carries loads across those distances.

B. Inspections can reveal damage before it becomes dangerous.

C. Engineers consider materials, support distances, and forces when designing bridges.

D. Bridge design and regular inspection help structures carry loads safely.

15. Read the passage: **The Life of a Monarch Butterfly**

Some monarch butterflies travel hundreds or thousands of miles during migration. In parts of North America, generations of monarchs move between breeding areas and warmer wintering locations. No single butterfly completes every part of the round trip. The journey depends on weather, food plants, and places to rest. Milkweed is especially important because monarch caterpillars feed on its leaves. Protecting milkweed and flowering plants can help provide food along the route.

Question: In the passage, what does “Migration” mean?

A. seasonal movement from one region to another

B. to arrange things so they work together

C. moves back and forth quickly

D. the place where something is going

16. Read the passage: **The Life of a Monarch Butterfly**

Some monarch butterflies travel hundreds or thousands of miles during migration. In parts of North America, generations of monarchs move between breeding areas and warmer wintering locations. No single butterfly completes every part of the round trip. The journey depends on weather, food plants, and places to rest. Milkweed is especially important because monarch caterpillars feed on its leaves. Protecting milkweed and flowering plants can help provide food along the route.

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A. Removing all milkweed from an area could make it harder for monarchs to reproduce.

B. Protecting milkweed and flowering plants helps provide food for monarchs.

C. Monarch caterpillars feed on milkweed leaves.

D. Monarch migration is a multigenerational journey that depends on suitable food and resting places.

17. Read the passage: **From Seed to Seedling**

A seed contains a young plant and stored food. When it receives enough water, oxygen, and suitable warmth, germination may begin. The seed coat softens or splits, and a root usually grows downward. A shoot grows upward toward light. Not every seed sprouts; some are damaged, too old, or in conditions that do not meet their needs. Gardeners can improve the chances of growth by using healthy seeds and keeping soil conditions suitable.

Question: In the passage, what does “Germination” mean?

A. the beginning of a seed’s growth

B. to arrange things so they work together

C. absolutely needed or very important

D. moves back and forth quickly

18. Read the passage: **From Seed to Seedling**

A seed contains a young plant and stored food. When it receives enough water, oxygen, and suitable warmth, germination may begin. The seed coat softens or splits, and a root usually grows downward. A shoot grows upward toward light. Not every seed sprouts; some are damaged, too old, or in conditions that do not meet their needs. Gardeners can improve the chances of growth by using healthy seeds and keeping soil conditions suitable.

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A. Seeds germinate when conditions allow the young plant to begin growing.

B. A root usually grows downward while a shoot grows upward toward light.

C. Seeds may fail to sprout if they are damaged or conditions are unsuitable.

D. A seed kept dry may not begin germinating even if it is healthy.

19. Read the passage: **Why Some Animals Are Nocturnal**

Nocturnal animals are active mainly at night. For some species, darkness offers a way to avoid daytime heat or certain predators. Other animals find food more easily when their prey is active after sunset. These animals may have adaptations such as large eyes, sensitive hearing, or a strong sense of smell. Not every night-active animal has all these traits, and being nocturnal does not mean an animal can see perfectly in total darkness.

Question: In the passage, what does “the key term” mean?

A. the place where something is going

B. to keep something from being lost or destroyed

C. to move something from one place to another

D. “Adaptations” are features or behaviors that help organisms survive.

20. Read the passage: **Why Some Animals Are Nocturnal**

Nocturnal animals are active mainly at night. For some species, darkness offers a way to avoid daytime heat or certain predators. Other animals find food more easily when their prey is active after sunset. These animals may have adaptations such as large eyes, sensitive hearing, or a strong sense of smell. Not every night-active animal has all these traits, and being nocturnal does not mean an animal can see perfectly in total darkness.

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A. Night activity can help some species avoid daytime heat or predators.

B. Some animals are active at night because it helps them find food or avoid difficult daytime conditions.

C. An animal that hunts prey active after sunset may benefit from being nocturnal.

D. Nocturnal animals may have large eyes, sensitive hearing, or a strong sense of smell.

21. Read the passage: **How a Newspaper Is Made**

A newspaper article often begins with reporting: a journalist gathers facts, interviews people, and checks documents. The writer then organizes the information so readers can understand what happened and why it matters. An editor may check clarity, accuracy, grammar, and fairness. Headlines summarize the main point in a few words, while photographs and captions can add context. Responsible newsrooms correct significant errors when they discover them.

Question: In the passage, what does “Context” mean?

A. a place where a particular activity is carried out

B. the place where something is going

C. the base that supports a building or structure

D. information that helps explain the meaning or situation

22. Read the passage: **How a Newspaper Is Made**

A newspaper article often begins with reporting: a journalist gathers facts, interviews people, and checks documents. The writer then organizes the information so readers can understand what happened and why it matters. An editor may check clarity, accuracy, grammar, and fairness. Headlines summarize the main point in a few words, while photographs and captions can add context. Responsible newsrooms correct significant errors when they discover them.

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A. Editors review articles to improve clarity, accuracy, grammar, and fairness.

B. A journalist should verify a surprising claim before publishing it.

C. Journalists may interview people and check documents before writing.

D. Producing a newspaper article involves gathering facts, writing, editing, and presenting information clearly.

23. Read the passage: **What Makes Soil Healthy?**

Healthy soil contains mineral particles, air, water, and decayed material from living things. Earthworms and tiny organisms break down dead leaves and other remains, helping return nutrients to the soil. Plant roots need spaces in the soil where air and water can move. Soil that is packed too tightly may make root growth difficult. Gardeners can protect soil by adding compost, limiting unnecessary digging, and keeping the ground covered when possible.

Question: In the passage, what does “the key term” mean?

A. “Nutrients” are substances organisms need to grow and stay healthy.

B. works with or handles information

C. moves back and forth quickly

D. information gathered by watching or measuring

24. Read the passage: **What Makes Soil Healthy?**

Healthy soil contains mineral particles, air, water, and decayed material from living things. Earthworms and tiny organisms break down dead leaves and other remains, helping return nutrients to the soil. Plant roots need spaces in the soil where air and water can move. Soil that is packed too tightly may make root growth difficult. Gardeners can protect soil by adding compost, limiting unnecessary digging, and keeping the ground covered when possible.

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A. Earthworms and tiny organisms help break down dead leaves and other remains.

B. Healthy soil supports plant growth through its materials, spaces, and living organisms.

C. Adding compost may improve soil by increasing decayed organic material.

D. Compacted soil can make it difficult for roots to grow.

25. Read the passage: **How Maps Tell Stories**

A map is a model of a place, but it cannot show every detail. A mapmaker chooses what information to include based on the map's purpose. A road map highlights routes, while a rainfall map may use colors to show how much rain different areas receive. A legend explains symbols and colors, and a scale relates map distance to real distance. Readers should check the title, legend, and scale before drawing conclusions from a map.

Question: In the passage, what does "the key term" mean?

A. works with or handles information

B. "Scale" shows the relationship between distance on a map and real distance.

C. the beginning of a seed's growth

D. a group of organisms of the same kind living in an area

26. Read the passage: **How Maps Tell Stories**

A map is a model of a place, but it cannot show every detail. A mapmaker chooses what information to include based on the map's purpose. A road map highlights routes, while a rainfall map may use colors to show how much rain different areas receive. A legend explains symbols and colors, and a scale relates map distance to real distance. Readers should check the title, legend, and scale before drawing conclusions from a map.

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A. A rainfall map may not be the best source for finding the quickest driving route.

B. Mapmakers choose different information depending on the map's purpose.

C. Maps select and display information for a purpose, so readers must understand their features.

D. A legend explains the symbols and colors used on a map.

27. Read the passage: **The Science of Sound**

Sound begins when an object vibrates. The vibrations travel through a material such as air, water, or a solid, reaching our ears. Sound usually travels faster through solids than through air because particles in many solids are close together. In a vacuum, where there are no particles to carry the vibrations, ordinary sound cannot travel. The loudness and pitch of a sound depend on different features of its vibrations.

Question: In the passage, what does "Vibrates" mean?

A. to keep something from being lost or destroyed

B. to move something from one place to another

C. well matched to a particular purpose or condition

D. moves back and forth quickly

28. Read the passage: **The Science of Sound**

Sound begins when an object vibrates. The vibrations travel through a material such as air, water, or a solid, reaching our ears. Sound usually travels faster through solids than through air because particles in many solids are close together. In a vacuum, where there are no particles to carry the vibrations, ordinary sound cannot travel. The loudness and pitch of a sound depend on different features of its vibrations.

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A. A person in a vacuum without a communication device would not hear an ordinary sound from nearby.

B. Sound often travels faster through solids because their particles are close together.

C. Sound is produced by vibrations that travel through matter to the ear.

D. Ordinary sound cannot travel through a vacuum because there are no particles to carry it.

29. Read the passage: **Why Communities Build Parks**

Parks give people places to exercise, play, rest, and meet neighbors. Trees and planted areas can provide shade and homes for birds and insects. A well-planned park may include paths, sports areas, quiet benches, and accessible entrances. However, parks need maintenance: litter must be removed, equipment checked, and plants cared for. Community surveys can help planners learn which features residents use and what improvements are needed.

Question: In the passage, what does “Accessible” mean?

A. well matched to a particular purpose or condition

B. information that helps explain the meaning or situation

C. weights or forces carried by a structure

D. designed so people with different needs can use it

30. Read the passage: **Why Communities Build Parks**

Parks give people places to exercise, play, rest, and meet neighbors. Trees and planted areas can provide shade and homes for birds and insects. A well-planned park may include paths, sports areas, quiet benches, and accessible entrances. However, parks need maintenance: litter must be removed, equipment checked, and plants cared for. Community surveys can help planners learn which features residents use and what improvements are needed.

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A. Parks may include paths, sports areas, quiet benches, and accessible entrances.

B. Parks offer recreation and nature, and thoughtful planning and maintenance help them serve a community.

C. If many residents use a park to walk, safe paths may be an important feature.

D. Community surveys help planners identify useful features and needed improvements.

31. Read the passage: **How Archaeologists Learn from Objects**

Archaeologists study objects and remains from past human communities. A broken pot, tool, or building foundation can provide clues about how people lived. The location of an object matters as much as the object itself because it may show how items were used together. Archaeologists record where objects are found and handle them carefully. A single object rarely answers every question, so researchers compare many clues before suggesting an explanation.

Question: In the passage, what does “Foundation” mean?

A. the base that supports a building or structure

B. overcrowding or a condition in which movement is slowed

C. a group of organisms of the same kind living in an area

D. to move something from one place to another

32. Read the passage: **How Archaeologists Learn from Objects**

Archaeologists study objects and remains from past human communities. A broken pot, tool, or building foundation can provide clues about how people lived. The location of an object matters as much as the object itself because it may show how items were used together. Archaeologists record where objects are found and handle them carefully. A single object rarely answers every question, so researchers compare many clues before suggesting an explanation.

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A. The location of an object can help explain how it was used.

B. Archaeologists use objects, their locations, and comparisons among clues to learn about past communities.

C. Researchers compare many clues because one object rarely answers every question.

D. Finding tools beside remains of a workshop could suggest that the space was used for making things.

33. Read the passage: **A Better Way to Save Water**

Fresh water is essential, but communities cannot use every drop of water on Earth. Much of the planet's water is salty, and some fresh water is frozen or deep underground. Homes can reduce waste by repairing leaks, taking shorter showers, and running full loads of laundry. Farms may use drip irrigation to deliver water close to plant roots. Saving water also reduces the energy needed to pump, heat, and treat it.

Question: In the passage, what does "Essential" mean?

A. information gathered by watching or measuring

B. the base that supports a building or structure

C. seasonal movement from one region to another

D. absolutely needed or very important

34. Read the passage: **A Better Way to Save Water**

Fresh water is essential, but communities cannot use every drop of water on Earth. Much of the planet's water is salty, and some fresh water is frozen or deep underground. Homes can reduce waste by repairing leaks, taking shorter showers, and running full loads of laundry. Farms may use drip irrigation to deliver water close to plant roots. Saving water also reduces the energy needed to pump, heat, and treat it.

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A. Because usable fresh water is limited, homes and farms can save water through practical choices.

B. A leaking tap wastes water even when no one is using it.

C. Saving water can also reduce the energy used to pump, heat, and treat it.

D. Drip irrigation delivers water close to plant roots.

35. Read the passage: **How the Postal System Moves a Letter**

A letter's journey begins when it is collected from a mailbox or post office. It is sorted by destination and sent to a processing center. Machines can read many addresses, but unclear writing may require a person to help. Letters travel by truck, plane, or other transport to a facility near the destination. Local carriers then deliver them. Correct addresses and postal codes help reduce delays, though weather and other problems can still slow delivery.

Question: In the passage, what does "Destination" mean?

A. the place where something is going

B. designed so people with different needs can use it

C. to produce or make something

D. taking part in an activity

36. Read the passage: **How the Postal System Moves a Letter**

A letter's journey begins when it is collected from a mailbox or post office. It is sorted by destination and sent to a processing center. Machines can read many addresses, but unclear writing may require a person to help. Letters travel by truck, plane, or other transport to a facility near the destination. Local carriers then deliver them. Correct addresses and postal codes help reduce delays, though weather and other problems can still slow delivery.

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A. A letter passes through several sorting, transport, and delivery stages before reaching its destination.

B. A letter with a missing postal code may take longer to sort.

C. Unclear writing may require a person to help sort a letter.

D. Correct addresses and postal codes help reduce delays.

37. Read the passage: **Why Museums Label Their Exhibits**

Museum labels help visitors understand what they are seeing. A label may identify an object, explain when and where it was made, and describe how it was used. Good labels use clear language and focus on details that help visitors notice something important. They may also explain that experts are still debating an object's meaning. Museum displays often combine objects, labels, images, and maps to tell a larger story.

Question: In the passage, what does "Significance" mean?

A. importance or meaning

B. to produce or make something

C. to arrange things so they work together

D. the beginning of a seed's growth

38. Read the passage: **Why Museums Label Their Exhibits**

Museum labels help visitors understand what they are seeing. A label may identify an object, explain when and where it was made, and describe how it was used. Good labels use clear language and focus on details that help visitors notice something important. They may also explain that experts are still debating an object's meaning. Museum displays often combine objects, labels, images, and maps to tell a larger story.

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A. A label may explain when and where an object was made and how it was used.

B. Clear labels help visitors notice important details about an exhibit.

C. A label that mentions disagreement among experts shows that some historical questions remain unsettled.

D. Museum labels provide context that helps visitors understand objects and their significance.

39. Read the passage: **The Importance of Sleep**

Sleep gives the body time to rest, and it also supports learning and memory. During sleep, the brain processes information gathered during the day. Children generally need more sleep than adults because their bodies and brains are developing. Bright screens and irregular bedtimes can make it harder for some people to fall asleep. A steady routine, a calm sleeping space, and enough time for rest can support healthy sleep habits.

Question: In the passage, what does "Processes" mean?

A. overcrowding or a condition in which movement is slowed

B. well matched to a particular purpose or condition

C. works with or handles information

D. weights or forces carried by a structure

40. Read the passage: **The Importance of Sleep**

Sleep gives the body time to rest, and it also supports learning and memory. During sleep, the brain processes information gathered during the day. Children generally need more sleep than adults because their bodies and brains are developing. Bright screens and irregular bedtimes can make it harder for some people to fall asleep. A steady routine, a calm sleeping space, and enough time for rest can support healthy sleep habits.

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A. Bright screens and irregular bedtimes can make falling asleep harder for some people.

B. A student who regularly sleeps too little may find it harder to focus in class.

C. During sleep, the brain processes information gathered during the day.

D. Sleep supports rest, learning, and development, and regular habits can make sleep easier.

41. Read the passage: **How Wind Turbines Make Electricity**

Wind turns the blades of a turbine. The blades spin a shaft connected to equipment that helps generate electricity. Turbines are often placed where winds are strong and steady, such as open plains or offshore areas. Wind power does not require burning fuel while generating electricity, but turbines still need materials, construction, maintenance, and connections to the electrical grid. Planners also consider wildlife, nearby residents, and how much wind a location receives.

Question: In the passage, what does “Generate” mean?

A. taking part in an activity

B. the beginning of a seed’s growth

C. to produce or make something

D. well matched to a particular purpose or condition

42. Read the passage: **How Wind Turbines Make Electricity**

Wind turns the blades of a turbine. The blades spin a shaft connected to equipment that helps generate electricity. Turbines are often placed where winds are strong and steady, such as open plains or offshore areas. Wind power does not require burning fuel while generating electricity, but turbines still need materials, construction, maintenance, and connections to the electrical grid. Planners also consider wildlife, nearby residents, and how much wind a location receives.

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A. A location with weak, unpredictable winds may be a poor choice for a wind farm.

B. Wind turns turbine blades, which spin a shaft connected to generating equipment.

C. Wind turbines convert moving air into electricity, and their locations require careful planning.

D. Planners study wind conditions because turbines work best where winds are strong and steady.

43. Read the passage: **What a Census Can Reveal**

A census is an organized count of the people living in a place. Governments use census information to understand population size and changes, such as where communities are growing. These data can help guide decisions about schools, roads, health services, and public resources. To be useful, a census needs broad participation and careful handling of information. Census results describe groups and communities; they do not explain every detail about an individual person.

Question: In the passage, what does “Participation” mean?

A. to arrange things so they work together

B. works with or handles information

C. taking part in an activity

D. the beginning of a seed’s growth

44. Read the passage: **What a Census Can Reveal**

A census is an organized count of the people living in a place. Governments use census information to understand population size and changes, such as where communities are growing. These data can help guide decisions about schools, roads, health services, and public resources. To be useful, a census needs broad participation and careful handling of information. Census results describe groups and communities; they do not explain every detail about an individual person.

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A. Census data can guide decisions about schools, roads, and health services.

B. Broad participation helps a census provide a more complete picture of a population.

C. Census information helps communities understand population patterns and plan public services.

D. A rapidly growing town may use census data when planning whether it needs another school.

45. Read the passage: **Why Some Rocks Have Layers**

Sedimentary rocks can form when sand, mud, and other small particles settle in layers. Over long periods, additional layers may press down on the material below. Minerals can help bind the particles together, turning loose sediment into rock. The layers may preserve clues about earlier environments, such as rivers, lakes, or ancient seas. Wind, water, and movement of Earth's crust can later expose or tilt these layers, so scientists study their arrangement carefully.

Question: In the passage, what does "Preserve" mean?

A. works with or handles information

B. overcrowding or a condition in which movement is slowed

C. to keep something from being lost or destroyed

D. seasonal movement from one region to another

46. Read the passage: **Why Some Rocks Have Layers**

Sedimentary rocks can form when sand, mud, and other small particles settle in layers. Over long periods, additional layers may press down on the material below. Minerals can help bind the particles together, turning loose sediment into rock. The layers may preserve clues about earlier environments, such as rivers, lakes, or ancient seas. Wind, water, and movement of Earth's crust can later expose or tilt these layers, so scientists study their arrangement carefully.

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A. Additional layers press down on material below, helping compact it over time.

B. Minerals can bind sediment particles together as rock forms.

C. A layer containing tiny sea-shell remains may suggest that the area once had a marine environment.

D. Sedimentary rocks form from layers of material and can preserve clues about past environments.

47. Read the passage: **How Public Transportation Helps**

Buses and trains can move many people using fewer vehicles than if everyone traveled separately by car. When routes are reliable and stops are convenient, public transportation can help people reach jobs, schools, shops, and services. It can also reduce road congestion, although crowded routes may need more vehicles or better schedules. Planning a transit system requires studying where people travel, when they travel, and whether stations and vehicles are accessible.

Question: In the passage, what does "Congestion" mean?

A. overcrowding or a condition in which movement is slowed

B. to arrange things so they work together

C. to move something from one place to another

D. designed so people with different needs can use it

48. Read the passage: **How Public Transportation Helps**

Buses and trains can move many people using fewer vehicles than if everyone traveled separately by car. When routes are reliable and stops are convenient, public transportation can help people reach jobs, schools, shops, and services. It can also reduce road congestion, although crowded routes may need more vehicles or better schedules. Planning a transit system requires studying where people travel, when they travel, and whether stations and vehicles are accessible.

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A. Public transportation can connect people and reduce some traffic problems when it is planned well.

B. A bus route that does not run when workers finish their shifts may not meet their needs.

C. Transit planners study where and when people travel.

D. Reliable routes and convenient stops make public transportation more useful.

49. Read the passage: **The Role of a Food Chain**

A food chain shows how energy moves from one organism to another as organisms eat. In a grassland, grass may be eaten by a grasshopper, which may be eaten by a frog, which may be eaten by a snake. Plants usually begin these chains because they use sunlight to make their own food. Real ecosystems contain many connected food chains, so a change in one population can affect several others.

Question: In the passage, what does “Population” mean?

A. seasonal movement from one region to another

B. a group of organisms of the same kind living in an area

C. a place where a particular activity is carried out

D. the place where something is going

50. Read the passage: **The Role of a Food Chain**

A food chain shows how energy moves from one organism to another as organisms eat. In a grassland, grass may be eaten by a grasshopper, which may be eaten by a frog, which may be eaten by a snake. Plants usually begin these chains because they use sunlight to make their own food. Real ecosystems contain many connected food chains, so a change in one population can affect several others.

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A. Food chains show energy moving among organisms, and connected chains make ecosystems interdependent.

B. Plants use sunlight to make their own food and often begin food chains.

C. A change in one population can affect other organisms connected to it.

D. If grass became scarce, grasshoppers might have less food, affecting animals that eat them.

Answer Key

Answers are listed by difficulty section and question number.

Easy

1. A 2. B 3. A 4. A 5. D 6. D 7. D 8. D 9. A 10. A

11. A 12. B 13. B 14. B 15. D 16. C 17. B 18. D 19. A 20. C

21. D 22. D 23. D 24. D 25. B 26. C 27. A 28. B 29. A 30. C

31. B 32. D 33. B 34. A 35. D 36. A 37. B 38. C 39. D 40. C

41. B 42. D 43. D 44. C 45. C 46. C 47. D 48. B 49. B 50. A

Medium

1. B 2. D 3. B 4. C 5. B 6. C 7. B 8. C 9. A 10. B

11. D 12. C 13. D 14. B 15. D 16. D 17. B 18. D 19. B 20. C

21. A 22. C 23. A 24. B 25. B 26. C 27. B 28. C 29. C 30. D

31. C 32. B 33. C 34. D 35. C 36. C 37. D 38. C 39. C 40. C

41. A 42. C 43. B 44. B 45. A 46. D 47. A 48. A 49. A 50. B

Hard

1. A 2. A 3. A 4. A 5. C 6. B 7. B 8. B 9. C 10. A

11. D 12. D 13. A 14. A 15. A 16. A 17. A 18. D 19. D 20. C

21. D 22. B 23. A 24. C 25. B 26. A 27. D 28. A 29. D 30. C

31. A 32. D 33. D 34. B 35. A 36. B 37. A 38. C 39. C 40. B

41. C 42. A 43. C 44. D 45. C 46. C 47. A 48. B 49. B 50. D